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The kinds of hand and wrist injuries that result from extended use of a computer while maintaining an incorrect posture are common among schoolchildren in Harnville. Computers are important to the school curriculum there, so instead of reducing the amount their students use computers, teachers plan to bring about a sharp reduction in the number of these injuries by carefully monitoring their students' posture when using computers in the classroom.

Which of the following would it be most useful to know in order to assess the likelihood that the teachers' plan will be successful?

A. Whether extended use of a computer while maintaining incorrect posture can cause injuries other than hand and wrist injuries

B. Whether hand and wrist injuries not caused by computer use are common among schoolchildren in Harnville

C. What proportion of schoolchildren in Harnville with hand and wrist injuries use computers extensively outside the classroom

D. Whether changes in the curriculum could reduce the schools' dependence on computers

E. What proportion of schoolchildren in Harnville already use correct posture while using a computer

•

A certain cultivated herb is one of a group of closely related plants that thrive in soil with high concentrations of metals that are toxic to most other plants. Agronomists studying the growth of this herb have discovered that it produces large amounts of histidine, an amino acid that, in test-tube solutions, renders these metals chemically inert. Hence, the herb's high histidine production must be the key feature that allows it to grow in metal-rich soils.

In evaluating the argument, it would be most important to determine which of the following?

A. Whether the herb can thrive in soil that does not have high concentrations of the toxic metals

B. Whether others of the closely related group of plants also produce histidine in large quantities

C. Whether the herb's high level of histidine production is associated with an unusually low level of production of some other amino acid

D. Whether growing the herb in soil with high concentrations of the metals will, over time, reduce their concentrations in the soil

E. Whether the concentration of histidine in the growing herb declines as the plant approaches maturity

•

Many people suffer an allergic reaction to certain sulfites, including those that are commonly added to wine as preservatives. However, since there are several winemakers who add sulfites to none of the wines they produce, people who would like to drink wine but are allergic to sulfites can drink wines produced by these winemakers without risking an allergic reaction to sulfites.

Which of the following is an assumption on which the argument depends?

A. These winemakers have been able to duplicate the preservative effect produced by adding sulfites by means that do not involve adding any potentially allergenic substances to their wine.

B. Not all forms of sulfite are equally likely to produce the allergic reaction.

C. Wine is the only beverage to which sulfites are commonly added.

D. Apart from sulfites, there are no substances commonly present in wine that give rise to an allergic reaction.

E. Sulfites are not naturally present in the wines produced by these winemakers in amounts large enough to produce an allergic reaction in someone who drinks these wines.

•

A new law gives ownership of patents—documents providing exclusive right to make and sell an invention—to universities, not the government, when those patents result from government-sponsored university research. Administrators at Logos University plan to sell any patents they acquire to corporations in order to fund programs to improve undergraduate teaching.

Which of the following, if true, would cast the most doubt on the viability of the college administrators' plan described above?

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described above?

A. Profit-making corporations interested in developing products based on patents held by universities are likely to try to serve as exclusive sponsors of ongoing university research projects.

B. Corporate sponsors of research in university facilities are entitled to tax credits under new federal tax-code guidelines.

C. Research scientists at Logos University have few or no teaching responsibilities and participate little if at all in the undergraduate programs in their field.

D. Government-sponsored research conducted at Logos University for the most part duplicates research already completed by several profitmaking corporations.

E. Logos University is unlikely to attract corporate sponsorship of its scientific research.

•

Since it has become known that **several of a bank's top executives have been buying shares in their own bank**, the bank's depositors, who had been worried by rumors that the bank faced impending financial collapse, have been greatly relieved. They reason that, since top executives evidently have faith in the bank's financial soundness, those worrisome rumors must be false. Such reasoning might well be overoptimistic, however, since **corporate executives have been known to buy shares in their own company in a calculated attempt to dispel negative rumors about the company's health.**

In the argument given, the two **boldfaced** portions play which of the following roles?

A. The first describes evidence that has been taken as supporting a conclusion; the second gives a reason for questioning that support.

B. The first describes evidence that has been taken as supporting a conclusion; the second states a contrary conclusion that is the main conclusion of the argument.

C. The first provides evidence in support of the main conclusion of the argument; the second states that conclusion.

D. The first describes the circumstance that the argument as a whole seeks to explain; the second gives the explanation that the argument seeks to establish.

E. The first describes the circumstance that the argument as a whole seeks to explain; the second provides evidence in support of the explanation that the argument seeks to establish.

•

Between 1980 and 2000, the sea otter population of the Aleutian Islands declined precipitously. There were no signs of disease or malnutrition, so there was probably an increase in the number of otters being eaten by predators. Orcas will eat otters when seals, their normal prey, are unavailable, and the Aleutian Islands seal population declined dramatically in the 1980s. Therefore, orcas were most likely the immediate cause of the otter population decline.

Which of the following, if true, most strengthens the argument?

A. The population of sea urchins, the main food of sea otters, has increased since the sea otter population declined.

B. Seals do not eat sea otters, nor do they compete with sea otters for food.

C. Most of the surviving sea otters live in a bay that is inaccessible to orcas.

D. The population of orcas in the Aleutian Islands has declined since the 1980s.

E. An increase in commercial fishing near the Aleutian Islands in the 1980s caused a slight decline in the population of the fish that seals use for food.

•

Political strategist: The domestic policies of our opponents in Party X are contrary to the priorities of many middle-class voters. Yet some of these same voters are supporters of Party X and its candidates due to the party's appeals about foreign policy. In order to win these voters back, we in Party Y must prove to middle-class voters that Party X does not represent their priorities with respect to domestic policy.

Which of the following would, if true, most strongly suggest that the political strategist's plan is unlikely to succeed?

A. Many in the middle class who support Party X for its foreign policies also support its domestic policies and are fully aware of the implications of those policies.

B. Most middle-class supporters of Party X care about foreign policy and know very little about its domestic

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B. Most middle-class supporters of Party X care about foreign policy and know very little about its domestic policies.

C. Long-term domestic policy sometimes conflicts with short-term domestic policy.

D. There are topics on which Party X and Party Y have significant agreement.

E. Some middle-class voters are concerned about both domestic and foreign policy.

•

Studies in restaurants show that the tips left by customers who pay their bill in cash tend to be larger when the bill is presented on a tray that bears a credit-card logo. Consumer psychologists hypothesize that simply seeing a credit-card logo makes many credit-card holders willing to spend more because it reminds them that their spending power exceeds the cash they have immediately available.

Which of the following, if true, most strongly supports the psychologists' interpretation of the studies?

A. The effect noted in the studies is not limited to patrons who have credit cards.

B. Patrons who are under financial pressure from their credit-card obligations tend to tip less when presented with a restaurant bill on a tray with a credit-card logo than when the tray has no logo.

C. In virtually all of the cases in the studies, the patrons who paid bills in cash did not possess credit cards.

D. In general, restaurant patrons who pay their bills in cash leave larger tips than do those who pay by credit card.

E. The percentage of restaurant bills paid with a given brand of credit card increases when that credit card's logo is displayed on the tray with which the bill is presented.

•

In an experiment, each volunteer was allowed to choose between an easy task and a hard task and was told that another volunteer would do the other task. Each volunteer could also choose to have a computer assign the two tasks randomly. Most volunteers chose the easy task for themselves and under questioning later said they had acted fairly. But when the scenario was described to another group of volunteers, almost all said choosing the easy task would be unfair. This shows that most people apply weaker moral standards to themselves than to others.

Which of the following is an assumption required by this argument?

A. At least some volunteers who said they had acted fairly in choosing the easy task would have said that it was unfair for someone else to do so.

B. The most moral choice for the volunteers would have been to have the computer assign the two tasks randomly.

C. There were at least some volunteers who were assigned to do the hard task and felt that the assignment was unfair.

D. On average, the volunteers to whom the scenario was described were more accurate in their moral judgments than the other volunteers were.

E. At least some volunteers given the choice between assigning the tasks themselves and having the computer assign them felt that they had made the only fair choice available to them.

•

Country X's recent stock-trading scandal should not diminish investors' confidence in the country's stock market. For one thing, **the discovery of the scandal confirms that Country X has a strong regulatory system**, as the following considerations show. In any stock market, some fraudulent activity is inevitable. If a stock market is well regulated, any significant stock-trading fraud in it will very likely be discovered. This deters potential perpetrators and facilitates improvement in regulatory processes.

In the argument, the portion in **boldface** plays which of the following roles?

A. It is the argument's only conclusion.

B. It is a conclusion for which the argument provides support and which itself is used to support the argument's main conclusion.

C. It is the argument's main conclusion and is supported by another explicitly stated conclusion for which further support is provided.

D. It is an assumption for which no explicit support is provided and is used to support the argument's only

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conclusion.

E. It is a compound statement containing both the argument's main conclusion and an assumption used to support that conclusion.

•

Delta Products Inc. has recently switched at least partly from older technologies using fossil fuels to new technologies powered by electricity. The question has been raised whether it can be concluded that **for a given level of output, Delta's operation now causes less fossil fuel to be consumed than it did formerly.** The answer, clearly, is yes, since the amount of fossil fuel used to generate the electricity needed to power the new technologies is less than the amount needed to power the older technologies, provided level of output is held constant.

In the argument given, the two **boldfaced** portions play which of the following roles?

A. The first identifies the content of the conclusion of the argument; the second provides support for that conclusion.

B. The first provides support for the conclusion of the argument; the second identifies the content of that conclusion.

C. The first states the conclusion of the argument; the second calls that conclusion into question.

D. The first provides support for the conclusion of the argument; the second calls that conclusion into question.

E. Each provides support for the conclusion of the argument.

•

A product that represents a clear technological advance over competing products can generally command a high price. Because **technological advances tend to be quickly surpassed** and companies want to make large profits while they still can, many companies charge the greatest price the market will bear when they have such a product. But **large profits on the new product will give competitors a strong incentive to quickly match the new product's capabilities.** Consequently, the strategy to maximize overall profit from a new product is to charge less than the greatest possible price.

In the argument above, the two portions in **boldface** play which of the following roles?

A. The first is an assumption that forms the basis for a course of action that the argument criticizes; the second presents the course of action endorsed by the argument.

B. The first is a consideration raised to explain the appeal of a certain strategy; the second is a consideration raised to call into question the wisdom of adopting that strategy.

C. The first is an assumption that has been used to justify a certain strategy; the second is a consideration that is used to cast doubt on that assumption.

D. The first is a consideration raised in support of a strategy the argument endorses; the second presents grounds in support of that consideration.

E. The first is a consideration raised to show that adopting a certain strategy is unlikely to achieve the intended effect; the second is presented to explain the appeal of that strategy.

•

Theater critic: The play *La Finestrina*, now at Central Theater, was written in Italy in the eighteenth century. The director claims that this production is as similar to the original production as is possible in a modern theater. Although the actor who plays Harlequin the clown gives a performance very reminiscent of the twentieth-century American comedian Groucho Marx, Marx's comic style was very much within the comic acting tradition that had begun in sixteenth-century Italy.

The considerations given best serve as part of an argument that

A. modern audiences would find it hard to tolerate certain characteristics of a historically accurate performance of an eighteenth-century play

B. Groucho Marx once performed the part of the character Harlequin in *La Finestrina*

C. in the United States, the training of actors in the twentieth century is based on principles that do not differ radically from those that underlay the training of actors in eighteenth-century Italy

D. the performance of the actor who plays Harlequin in *La Finestrina* does not serve as evidence against the

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D. the performance of the actor who plays Harlequin in *La Finestrina* does not serve as evidence against the director's claim

E. the director of *La Finestrina* must have advised the actor who plays Harlequin to model his performance on comic performances of Groucho Marx

•

Although the discount stores in Goreville's central shopping district are expected to close within five years as a result of competition from a SpendLess discount department store that just opened, those locations will not stay vacant for long. In the five years since the opening of Colson's, a nondiscount department store, a new store has opened at the location of every store in the shopping district that closed because it could not compete with Colson's.

Which of the following, if true, most seriously weakens the argument?

A. Many customers of Colson's are expected to do less shopping there than they did before the SpendLess store opened.

B. Increasingly, the stores that have opened in the central shopping district since Colson's opened have been discount stores.

C. At present, the central shopping district has as many stores operating in it as it ever had.

D. Over the course of the next five years, it is expected that Goreville's population will grow at a faster rate than it has for the past several decades.

E. Many stores in the central shopping district sell types of merchandise that are not available at either SpendLess or Colson's.

•

Last year all refuse collected by Shelbyville city services was incinerated. This incineration generated a large quantity of residual ash. In order to reduce the amount of residual ash Shelbyville generates this year to half of last year's total, the city has revamped its collection program. This year city services will separate for recycling enough refuse to reduce the number of truckloads of refuse to be incinerated to half of last year's number.

Which of the following is required for the revamped collection program to achieve its aim?

A. This year no materials that city services could separate for recycling will be incinerated.

B. Separating recyclable materials from materials to be incinerated will cost Shelbyville less than half what it cost last year to dispose of the residual ash.

C. Refuse collected by city services will contain a larger proportion of recyclable materials this year than it did last year.

D. The refuse incinerated this year will generate no more residual ash per truckload incinerated than did the refuse incinerated last year.

E. The total quantity of refuse collected by Shelbyville city services this year will be no greater than that collected last year.

•

Veterinarians generally derive some of their income from selling several manufacturers' lines of pet-care products. Knowing that pet owners rarely throw away mail from their pet's veterinarian unread, one manufacturer of pet-care products offered free promotional materials on its products to veterinarians for mailing to their clients. Very few veterinarians accepted the offer, however, even though the manufacturer's products are of high quality.

Which of the following, if true, most helps to explain the veterinarians' reaction to the manufacturer's promotional scheme?

A. Most of the veterinarians to whom the free promotional materials were offered were already selling the manufacturer's pet-care products to their clients.

B. The special promotional materials were intended as a supplement to the manufacturer's usual promotional activities rather than as a replacement for them.

C. The manufacturer's products, unlike most equally good competing products sold by veterinarians, are also available in pet stores and in supermarkets.

D. Many pet owners have begun demanding quality in products they buy for their pets that is as high as that in

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products they buy for themselves.

E. Veterinarians sometimes recommend that pet owners use products formulated for people when no suitable product specially formulated for animals is available.

•

The average hourly wage of television assemblers in Vernland has long been significantly lower than that in neighboring Borodia. Since Borodia dropped all tariffs on Vernlandian televisions three years ago, the number of televisions sold annually in Borodia has not changed. However, recent statistics show a drop in the number of television assemblers in Borodia. Therefore, updated trade statistics will probably indicate that the number of televisions Borodia imports annually from Vernland has increased.

Which of the following is an assumption on which the argument depends?

A. The number of television assemblers in Vernland has increased by at least as much as the number of television assemblers in Borodia has decreased.

B. Televisions assembled in Vernland have features that televisions assembled in Borodia do not have.

C. The average number of hours it takes a Borodian television assembler to assemble a television has not decreased significantly during the past three years.

D. The number of televisions assembled annually in Vernland has increased significantly during the past three years.

E. The difference between the hourly wage of television assemblers in Vernland and the hourly wage of television assemblers in Borodia is likely to decrease in the next few years.

•

Guidebook writer: I have visited hotels throughout the country and have noticed that in those built before 1930 the quality of the original carpentry work is generally superior to that in hotels built afterward. Clearly, carpenters working on hotels before 1930 typically worked with more skill, care, and effort than carpenters who have worked on hotels built subsequently.

Which of the following, if true, most seriously weakens the guidebook writer's argument?

A. The quality of original carpentry in hotels is generally far superior to the quality of original carpentry in other structures, such as houses and stores.

B. Hotels built since 1930 can generally accommodate more guests than those built before 1930.

C. The materials available to carpenters working before 1930 were not significantly different in quality from the materials available to carpenters working after 1930.

D. The better the quality of original carpentry in a building, the less likely that building is to fall into disuse and be demolished.

E. The average length of apprenticeship for carpenters has declined significantly since 1930.

•

Most of Western music since the Renaissance has been based on a seven-note scale known as the diatonic scale, but when did the scale originate? A fragment of a bone flute excavated at a Neanderthal campsite has four holes, which are spaced in exactly the right way for playing the third through sixth notes of a diatonic scale. **The entire flute must surely have had more holes**, and the flute was made from a bone that was long enough for these additional holes to have allowed a complete diatonic scale to be played. Therefore, **the Neanderthals who made the flute probably used a diatonic musical scale**.

In the argument given, the two portions in **boldface** play which of the following roles?

A. The first is presented as evidence that is confirmed by data presented elsewhere in the argument given; the second states a hypothesis this evidence is used to undermine.

B. The first is an opinion for which no supporting evidence is presented in the argument given, which is used to support the main conclusion of the argument; the second is that main conclusion.

C. The first describes a discovery as undermining the position against which the argument is directed; the second states the main conclusion of the argument.

D. The first is a preliminary conclusion drawn on the basis of evidence presented elsewhere in the argument given;

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D. The first is a preliminary conclusion drawn on the basis of evidence presented elsewhere in the argument given; the second is the main conclusion this preliminary conclusion supports.

E. The first provides evidence to support the main conclusion of the argument; the second states a subsidiary conclusion that is drawn in order to support the main conclusion stated earlier in the argument.

•

NorthAir charges low fares for its economy-class seats, but it provides very cramped seating and few amenities. Market research shows that economy passengers would willingly pay more for wider seating and better service, and additional revenue provided by these higher ticket prices would more than cover the additional cost of providing these amenities. Even though NorthAir is searching for ways to improve its profitability, it has decided not to make these improvements.

Which of the following, if true, would most help to explain NorthAir's decision in light of its objectives?

A. None of NorthAir's competitors offers significantly better seating and service to economy-class passengers than NorthAir does.

B. On many of the routes that NorthAir flies, it is the only airline to offer direct flights.

C. A few of NorthAir's economy-class passengers are satisfied with the service they receive, given the low price they pay.

D. Very few people avoid flying on NorthAir because of the cramped seating and poor service offered in economy class.

E. The number of people who would be willing to pay the high fares NorthAir charges for its business-class seats would decrease if its economy-class seating were more acceptable.

•

Which of the following most logically completes the argument given?

Asthma, a chronic breathing disorder, is significantly more common today among adult competitive swimmers than it is among competitive athletes who specialize in other sports. Although chlorine is now known to be a lung irritant and swimming pool water is generally chlorinated, it would be rash to assume that frequent exposure to chlorine is the explanation of the high incidence of asthma among these swimmers, since _____.

A. young people who have asthma are no more likely to become competitive athletes than are young people who do not have asthma

B. competitive athletes who specialize in sports other than swimming are rarely exposed to chlorine

C. competitive athletes as a group have a significantly lower incidence of asthma than do people who do not participate in competitive athletics

D. until a few years ago, physicians routinely recommended competitive swimming to children with asthma, in the belief that this form of exercise could alleviate asthma symptoms

E. many people have asthma without knowing they have it and thus are not diagnosed with the condition until they begin engaging in very strenuous activities, such as competitive athletics

•

In the country of Marut, the Foreign Trade Agency's records were reviewed in 1994 in light of information then newly available about neighboring Goro. The review revealed that in every year since 1963, the agency's projection of what Goro's gross national product (GNP) would be five years later was a serious underestimate. The review also revealed that in every year since 1963, the agency estimated Goro's GNP for the previous year—a Goro state secret—very accurately.

Of the following claims, which is most strongly supported by the statements given?

A. Goro's GNP fluctuated greatly between 1963 and 1994.

B. Prior to 1995, Goro had not released data intended to mislead the agency in making its five-year projections.

C. The amount by which the agency underestimated the GNP it projected for Goro tended to increase over time.

D. Even before the new information came to light, the agency had reason to think that at least some of the five-year projections it had made were inaccurate.

E. The agency's five-year projections of Goro's GNP had no impact on economic planning in Marut.

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E. The agency's five-year projections of Goro's GNP had no impact on economic planning in Marat.

•

Vargonia has just introduced a legal requirement that student-teacher ratios in government-funded schools not exceed a certain limit. All Vargonian children are entitled to education, free of charge, in these schools. When a recession occurs and average incomes fall, the number of children enrolled in government-funded schools tends to increase. Therefore, though most employment opportunities contract in economic recessions, getting a teaching job in Vargonia's government-funded schools will not be made more difficult by a recession.

Which of the following would be most important to determine in order to evaluate the argument?

A. Whether in Vargonia there are any schools not funded by the government that offer children an education free of charge

B. Whether the number of qualified applicants for teaching positions in government-funded schools increases significantly during economic recessions

C. What the current student-teacher ratio in Vargonia's government-funded schools is

D. What proportion of Vargonia's workers currently hold jobs as teachers in government-funded schools

E. Whether in the past a number of government-funded schools in Vargonia have had student-teacher ratios well in excess of the new limit

•

In Colorado subalpine meadows, nonnative dandelions co-occur with a native flower, the larkspur. Bumblebees visit both species, creating the potential for interactions between the two species with respect to pollination. In a recent study, researchers selected 16 plots containing both species; all dandelions were removed from eight plots; the remaining eight control plots were left undisturbed. The control plots yielded significantly more larkspur seeds than the dandelion-free plots, leading the researchers to conclude that the presence of dandelions facilitates pollination (and hence seed production) in the native species by attracting more pollinators to the mixed plots.

Which of the following, if true, most seriously undermines the researchers' reasoning?

A. Bumblebees preferentially visit dandelions over larkspurs in mixed plots.

B. In mixed plots, pollinators can transfer pollen from one species to another to augment seed production.

C. If left unchecked, nonnative species like dandelions quickly crowd out native species.

D. Seed germination is a more reliable measure of a species' fitness than seed production.

E. Soil disturbances can result in fewer blooms, and hence lower seed production.

•

Paleontologist: About 2.8 million years ago, many species that lived near the ocean floor suffered substantial population declines. These declines coincided with the onset of an ice age. The notion that cold killed those bottom-dwelling creatures outright is misguided, however; temperatures near the ocean floor would have changed very little. Nevertheless, **the cold probably did cause the population declines, though indirectly**. Many bottom-dwellers depended on plankton, small organisms that lived close to the surface and sank to the bottom when they died, for food. **Most probably, the plankton suffered a severe population decline as a result of sharply lower temperatures at the surface,** depriving many bottom-dwellers of food.

In the paleontologist's reasoning, the two portions in **boldface** play which of the following roles?

A. The first introduces the hypothesis proposed by the paleontologist; the second is a judgment offered in spelling out that hypothesis.

B. The first introduces the hypothesis proposed by the paleontologist; the second is a position the paleontologist opposes.

C. The first is an explanation challenged by the paleontologist; the second is an explanation proposed by the paleontologist.

D. The first is a judgment advanced in support of a conclusion reached by the paleontologist; the second is that conclusion.

E. The first is a generalization put forward by the paleontologist; the second presents certain exceptional cases in which that generalization does not hold.

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•

With seventeen casinos, Moneyland operates the most casinos in a certain state. Although intent on expanding, it was outmaneuvered by Apex Casinos in negotiations to acquire the Eldorado chain. To complete its acquisition of Eldorado, Apex must sell five casinos to comply with a state law forbidding any owner to operate more than one casino per county. Since Apex will still be left operating twenty casinos in the state, it will then have the most casinos in the state.

Which of the following, if true, most seriously undermines the prediction?

A. Apex, Eldorado, and Moneyland are the only organizations licensed to operate casinos in the state.

B. The majority of Eldorado's casinos in the state will need extensive renovations if they are to continue to operate profitably.

C. Some of the state's counties do not permit casinos.

D. Moneyland already operates casinos in the majority of the state's counties.

E. Apex will use funds it obtains from the sale of the five casinos to help fund its acquisition of the Eldorado chain.

•

It is widely assumed that people need to engage in intellectual activities such as solving crossword puzzles or mathematics problems in order to maintain mental sharpness as they age. In fact, however, simply talking to other people—that is, participating in social interaction, which engages many mental and perceptual skills—suffices. Evidence to this effect comes from a study showing that the more social contact people report, the better their mental skills.

Which of the following, if true, most seriously weakens the force of the evidence cited?

A. As people grow older, they are often advised to keep exercising their physical and mental capacities in order to maintain or improve them.

B. Many medical conditions and treatments that adversely affect a person's mental sharpness also tend to increase that person's social isolation.

C. Many people are proficient both in social interactions and in solving mathematical problems.

D. The study did not itself collect data but analyzed data bearing on the issue from prior studies.

E. The tasks evaluating mental sharpness for which data were compiled by the study were more akin to mathematics problems than to conversation.

•

In the United States, of the people who moved from one state to another when they retired, the percentage who retired to Florida has decreased by three percentage points over the past ten years. Since many local businesses in Florida cater to retirees, these declines are likely to have a noticeably negative economic effect on these businesses and therefore on the economy of Florida.

Which of the following, if true, most seriously weakens the argument given?

A. People who moved from one state to another when they retired moved a greater distance, on average, last year than such people did ten years ago.

B. People were more likely to retire to North Carolina from another state last year than people were ten years ago.

C. The number of people who moved from one state to another when they retired has increased significantly over the past ten years.

D. The number of people who left Florida when they retired to live in another state was greater last year than it was ten years ago.

E. Florida attracts more people who move from one state to another when they retire than does any other state.

•

The spacing of the four holes on a fragment of a bone flute excavated at a Neanderthal campsite is just what is required to play the third through sixth notes of the diatonic scale—the seven-note musical scale used in much of Western music since the Renaissance. Musicologists therefore hypothesize that the diatonic musical scale was developed and used thousands of years before it was adopted by Western musicians.

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Which of the following, if true, most strongly supports the hypothesis?

A. Bone flutes were probably the only musical instrument made by Neanderthals.

B. No musical instrument that is known to have used a diatonic scale is of an earlier date than the flute found at the Neanderthal campsite.

C. The flute was made from a cave-bear bone, and the campsite at which the flute fragment was excavated was in a cave that also contained skeletal remains of cave bears.

D. Flutes are the simplest wind instrument that can be constructed to allow playing a diatonic scale.

E. The cave-bear leg bone used to make the Neanderthal flute would have been long enough to make a flute capable of playing a complete diatonic scale.

•

Which of the following most logically completes the passage?

The figures in portraits by the Spanish painter El Greco (1541–1614) are systematically elongated. In El Greco's time, the intentional distortion of human figures was unprecedented in European painting. Consequently, some critics have suggested that El Greco had an astigmatism, a type of visual impairment, that resulted in people appearing to him in the distorted way that is characteristic of his paintings. However, this suggestion cannot be the explanation, because _____.

A. several twentieth-century artists have consciously adopted from El Greco's paintings the systematic elongation of the human form

B. some people do have elongated bodies somewhat like those depicted in El Greco's portraits

C. if El Greco had an astigmatism, then, relative to how people looked to him, the elongated figures in his paintings would have appeared to him to be distorted

D. even if El Greco had an astigmatism, there would have been no correction for it available in the period in which he lived

E. there were non-European artists, even in El Greco's time, who included in their works human figures that were intentionally distorted

•

Museums that house Renaissance oil paintings typically store them in environments that are carefully kept within narrow margins of temperature and humidity to inhibit any deterioration. Laboratory tests have shown that the kind of oil paint used in these paintings actually adjusts to climatic changes quite well. If, as some museum directors believe, **paint is the most sensitive substance in these works**, then by relaxing the standards for temperature and humidity control, **museums can reduce energy costs without risking damage to these paintings.** Museums would be rash to relax those standards, however, since results of preliminary tests indicate that gesso, a compound routinely used by Renaissance artists to help paint adhere to the canvas, is unable to withstand significant variations in humidity.

In the argument above, the two portions in **boldface** play which of the following roles?

A. The first is an objection that has been raised against the position taken by the argument; the second is the position taken by the argument.

B. The first is the position taken by the argument; the second is the position that the argument calls into question.

C. The first is a judgment that has been offered in support of the position that the argument calls into question; the second is a circumstance on which that judgment is, in part, based.

D. The first is a judgment that has been offered in support of the position that the argument calls into question; the second is that position.

E. The first is a claim that the argument calls into question; the second is the position taken by the argument.

•

Codex Berinensis, a Florentine copy of an ancient Roman medical treatise, is undated but contains clues to when it was produced. Its first 80 pages are by a single copyist, but the remaining 20 pages are by three different copyists, which indicates some significant disruption. Since a letter in handwriting, identified as that of the fourth copyist, mentions a plague that killed many people in Florence in 1148, Codex Berinensis was probably produced in that year.

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Which of the following, if true, most strongly supports the hypothesis that Codex Berinensis was produced in 1148?

A. Other than Codex Berinensis, there are no known samples of the handwriting of the first three copyists.

B. According to the account by the fourth copyist, the plague went on for 10 months.

C. A scribe would be able to copy a page of text the size and style of Codex Berinensis in a day.

D. There was only one outbreak of plague in Florence in the 1100s.

E. The number of pages of Codex Berinensis produced by a single scribe becomes smaller with each successive change of copyist.

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Excavations of the Roman city of Sepphoris have uncovered numerous detailed mosaics depicting several readily identifiable animal species: a hare, a partridge, and various Mediterranean fish. Oddly, most of the species represented did not live in the Sepphoris region when these mosaics were created. Since identical motifs appear in mosaics found in other Roman cities, however, the mosaics of Sepphoris were very likely created by traveling artisans from some other part of the Roman Empire.

Which of the following is an assumption on which the argument depends?

A. The Sepphoris mosaics are not composed exclusively of types of stones found naturally in the Sepphoris area.

B. There is no single region to which all the species depicted in the Sepphoris mosaics are native.

C. No motifs appear in the Sepphoris mosaics that do not also appear in the mosaics of some other Roman city.

D. All of the animal figures in the Sepphoris mosaics are readily identifiable as representations of known species.

E. There was not a common repertory of mosaic designs with which artisans who lived in various parts of the Roman Empire were familiar.

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As a large corporation in a small country, Hachnut wants its managers to have international experience, so **each year it sponsors management education abroad for its management trainees.** Hachnut has found, however, that the attrition rate of graduates from this program is very high, with many of them leaving Hachnut to join competing firms soon

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